Client Finder Agent PRO

OUTREACH GUIDE

Outreach playbook

From lead to paying client, with a calm daily routine and honest outreach.

Version 1.0.0 · Tested on n8n 1.123.83 and 2.42.3

Contents

The system in one page

Choosing your niche, area and business types

Designing an offer they can say yes to

Setting up your inbox

Your daily 45-minute routine

How to review a draft in 30 seconds

Recording the free video audit

Calls and DMs for leads without email

Following up

Handling replies

Turning a reply into a paying client

Metrics to track with the Pipeline tab

Rules for cold email

A 30-day launch plan

Common mistakes

The system in one page

Client Finder Agent finds the leads. Your job is to turn a few of them into conversations, and a few conversations into clients.

An honest note first: nothing here guarantees replies, clients or income. Results vary widely by niche, country, offer and how carefully you work. What you get is a routine that respects the people you write to and protects your reputation.

The process has eight steps. The workflow does the first three; you do the rest.

Step	Who	What happens
1. Find	Workflow	Up to 60 businesses per search, from Google's official Places API
2. Check and score	Workflow	Problems your niche can fix, and a score from 0 to 100
3. Write	Workflow	An email, a DM and a call opener from verified evidence; a Gmail draft when the homepage shows an email address
4. Review and send	You	Check each draft in 30 seconds; send the best 10-20 a day
5. Call or DM	You	Leads with no public email get a call or a short message
6. Follow up	Autopilot and you	Up to 2 polite follow-up drafts in the same thread; you send them
7. Reply	You	Answer every reply within a day and offer a short call
8. Win	You	A short call, a one-page proposal and a clear price

Three ideas hold it together:

1. **Evidence first.** Every pitch starts with one checked fact about the business that anyone can see for themselves, and you confirm it before you send. That makes it different from generic spam.
2. **A small first step.** The first email asks for no meeting and no money. It offers something free and useful, like a 2-minute video.
3. **Slow and steady.** 10-20 careful emails every working day are better than 200 rushed ones. They protect your inbox and your name.

Leads (example data) — dentists in Austin, TX

Business	Score	Priority	Problems	Email	Status
Bright Smile Studio	85	Hot	Not mobile-friendly, Not secure (no HTTPS), Outdated website, Weak SEO basics	smile@bright-smile.test	Pitch ready
Sunrise Family Dental, PLLC	50	Warm	Slow on mobile, Outdated website	info@sunrise-dental.test	Draft ready
Lakeside Dental Care	45	Warm	No website		Pitch ready
Oak Hill Orthodontics	45	Warm	Website down		Pitch ready
Maple Dental Group	45	Warm	Website down		Pitch ready
Pearl Dental Spa	40	Warm	Security certificate error		Pitch ready
Cedar Park Smiles	40	Warm	Placeholder website		Pitch ready
Elm Street Dental	10	Low	Weak SEO basics	contact@elm-dental.test	New
Downtown Dentistry	0	None		hello@downtown-dentistry.test	New

Example data from a search for dentists in Austin, TX. Your leads will differ.

Choosing your niche, area and business types

Your *niche* is the service you sell. Pro has five Client Finder workflows, one per niche. Start with one, even if you can do more: one offer, one video style, one set of words to practise. Add a second niche after a month, when your routine works.

Who can afford your service

A business can only pay you well if a new customer is worth a lot to it. Ask four questions:

1. **Is one new customer worth a lot?** A new dental patient may come back for years; a café needs many new customers to cover your fee.
2. **Does the problem cost them customers?** A website that takes 10 seconds to load, or a 3.6-star rating, is easy to understand.
3. **Can one person say yes?** Owner-run businesses decide quickly. Chains usually decide at head office, so skip them.
4. **Can they afford it?** Many reviews and years in business are good signs.

Business types to try in each niche

Niche (workflow)	Business types to try	Why they fit
Web Design	dentists, physiotherapists, law firms, accountants, plumbers, roofers, landscapers, wedding venues	Valuable customers check the website before they call
Local SEO	plumbers, HVAC companies, roofers, locksmiths, pest control, car repair, dentists, lawyers	People search "near me" when they need help now

Niche (workflow)	Business types to try	Why they fit
Google Reviews & Reputation	hair salons, barbers, restaurants, car repair, beauty clinics, vets, driving schools	Customers compare star ratings on Google Maps
Social Media & Ads	gyms, yoga studios, restaurants, bakeries, boutiques, salons, real estate agents	Visual businesses that customers check on Instagram
AI Chatbots & Booking	physiotherapy clinics, dental clinics, vets, spas, salons, tutoring centres, driving schools	Appointment businesses with repeated questions and after-hours enquiries

Type the business type the way customers search: plural and simple (`physiotherapy clinics`, not `physio`). Then try close variants, such as `dentists`, `dental clinics` and `orthodontists`. The workflow always skips businesses already in your sheet. It also never pitches an email address or website twice: another location of a chain, or a duplicate listing, is saved with a note like "Same email as ..." and the **AI Status** "Skipped (already pitched)".

> **Tip:** If a search returns a chain, or a business you don't want to pitch, delete its Gmail draft. Set its **Status** to **New** and write the reason in **Notes**, for example `Not pitched: chain`. Keep its **Place ID**: it stops the business from being added again.

Big city or smaller towns?

Google returns at most 60 businesses per search. Businesses that serve an area without a shopfront, like many plumbers, cleaners and mobile trades, are included.

- **Big cities:** search by neighbourhood or suburb, for example `dentists` in `Brooklyn, NY` or `Koramangala, Bangalore`. Expect competition: other agencies may already be writing to the same businesses.
- **Smaller towns:** fewer businesses per search, so you move from town to town faster. Owners may get fewer pitches. A local angle ("I work with businesses around Leeds") can help, but only if it is true. Budgets may be smaller.

A good start is one region you know, split into 5-10 areas, with 3 business types. That gives you weeks of searches.

Your home market or English-speaking markets?

Many freelancers in India and elsewhere pitch businesses in the US, the UK, Canada or Australia. Know the trade-offs.

	Your home market	US, UK, Canada, Australia
Prices	Often lower	Often higher for the same work

	Your home market	US, UK, Canada, Australia
Trust	You can meet in person and share a language	You are a stranger far away, so your evidence and video must earn trust
Time zones	The same as yours	Calls may be early or late for you
Rules	One set to learn	Different per country; Canada and Australia are strict

Set ⚙️ *Settings* to match the market: **searchCountryCode** (for example `US`, `GB`, `CA`, `AU` or `IN`), **searchLanguage** for Google Maps results, and **emailLanguage** for pitches (for example `British English` for the UK).

> **Important:** Never pretend to be local. Put your real name and postal address in every signature. If someone asks where you are, tell them. Honest remote work is normal; a fake local identity destroys trust.

Designing an offer they can say yes to

Your *offer* is the small next step at the end of every first email, set in **yourOffer** in ⚙️ *Settings*. The first email asks for no meeting, quote or money, only something like: "Would it be useful if I sent you this?" Saying yes costs the owner nothing.

Three offer types

1. **The free 2-minute video audit.** You record your screen while you walk through their website, Google profile or reviews and show what you would fix. It is personal and proves you really looked. It is the Web Design default.
2. **The mini-audit.** One page with the 3 most useful fixes, in plain words. It suits Local SEO and Reviews.
3. **The mock-up.** A quick picture of how their homepage, Instagram grid or booking page could look. It takes the most time, so keep it for **Hot** leads (score 60 or more).

PROMPTS.pdf has ready-to-paste offers for each niche.

Make it specific

A specific offer shows that you looked. Link it to the main problem in the **Top Problem** and **Evidence** columns. Claude already does this; in your best drafts you can make it sharper by hand.

Example: Example data from the product's test businesses. Each offer names the problem the workflow found.

- **Sunrise Family Dental** (Web Design): 23/100 in Google's PageSpeed mobile test (a simulated phone), and the footer still shows © 2019. Offer: "a 2-minute video showing why the main content of your homepage takes about 10 seconds to appear on a phone, and the 3 things I would change."
- **Elm Street Dental** (Local SEO): no page title or meta description, and 8 Google reviews while the median nearby is 133. Offer: "a one-page mini-audit with the 3 fixes that would help you show up in local searches."
- **Hillcrest Family Dentistry** (Reviews): 3.6 stars from 48 reviews; similar businesses nearby average 4.6. Offer: "a one-page plan to get more reviews from patients you already have."
- **Westlake Dental Studio** (AI Chatbots & Booking): no booking button or chat found on the homepage, and closed all weekend according to Google. Offer: "a 5-minute demo of an assistant that answers weekend questions using your own website."

A *median* is the middle value: half of the businesses have more reviews, and half have fewer.

Whatever you offer, make sure you can deliver it within 48 hours, even in a busy week. It should be useful even if they never hire you, and promise nothing you cannot control: no "first page on Google", no "50 new reviews".

Setting up your inbox

If your emails land in spam, nothing else matters. This setup takes about an hour, once.

Use an address on your own domain

A *domain* is your website's name, like `pixelpine.studio` (a made-up example). An address like `asha@pixelpine.studio` looks like a real business; a free `@gmail.com` address works, but owners may take it less seriously. We suggest Google Workspace, Google's paid business version of Gmail. It looks like normal Gmail, and n8n's Gmail credential works with it. Check Google's website for prices in your country.

Important: Drafts appear in the Gmail account of the credential selected on *Create Gmail Draft*. If you move to a new inbox, connect it in n8n and select it on *Create Gmail Draft*, and on *Search Gmail*, *Read Gmail Threads* and *Create Follow-up Draft* in the Follow-up Autopilot. Always send from the account where the drafts were created, so the Autopilot can see what you sent.

Optional: a separate outreach domain

Some freelancers send cold email from a second domain, like `pixelpine-studio.com`, so spam reports affect their main domain less. It costs extra, and a new domain must start even slower. Use a name close to your real business, forward its website to your main one, and never use a name that looks like another company's brand.

SPF, DKIM and DMARC, explained simply

These are three short text records in your domain's *DNS* settings: a settings page at the company where you bought your domain or at your website host. They prove to Gmail, Outlook and others that your emails really come from you. Google's sender guidelines ask every sender to set up at least SPF or DKIM. Set up all three.

Record	What it does, in plain words	What to add for Google Workspace
SPF	A list of the servers that may send email for your domain	Type `TXT`, host `@`, value `v=spf1 include:_spf.google.com ~all`
DKIM	A digital signature on every email, so receivers know it was not faked or changed	Type `TXT`, host `google._domainkey`, value created in the Google Admin console (steps below)
DMARC	Tells receivers what to do with email that fails SPF and DKIM, and sends you reports	Type `TXT`, host `_dmarc`, value `v=DMARC1; p=none; rua=mailto:you@yourdomain.com`

To turn on DKIM in Google Workspace:

1. In the Google Admin console (admin.google.com), go to **Apps** > **Google Workspace** > **Gmail** > **Authenticate email**.
2. Click **Generate new record** and copy the TXT record value.
3. Add it at your DNS host with the host name shown (usually `google._domainkey`).
4. When the change is live (it can take up to 48 hours), click **Start authentication**.

> **Warning:** A domain can have only one SPF record. If one already exists, for example from your website host, add `include:_spf.google.com` inside it instead of creating a second one. If unsure, ask your domain host's support team.

To check, send an email to another address of yours and open it in Gmail. Click the three dots (**More**), then **Show original**. You want `PASS` next to SPF, DKIM and DMARC. (`p=none` means "report only, don't block". When all your real email passes for a few weeks, you can change it to `p=quarantine`.)

Start slowly: 10-20 emails a day

A new address that suddenly writes to many strangers looks suspicious to spam filters. Grow step by step:

1. **Week 1:** about 10 first emails a day, plus normal emails to people you know.
2. **Week 2:** about 15 a day.
3. **Week 3 onward:** about 20 a day, but only while bounces and spam complaints stay rare. A *bounce* is an email that comes back undelivered. We suggest you stay at about 20-30 new emails a day per inbox. You review each one by hand, so more is rarely practical anyway.

With a brand-new outreach domain, start at about 5 a day. Whatever your volume, send a few at a time through the day, not all in one minute.

Google's sender guidelines ask senders to keep spam complaints very low: below 0.3% of messages, and ideally below 0.1%. For a small sender, that means almost nobody should click **Report spam**. No number is safe for everyone: if you see bounces, or hear that you landed in spam, slow down.

Plain text, no links, no attachments

The workflow already creates plain-text drafts with no links. In your first email, keep it that way: no links except your own website in the signature, no link shorteners or tracking, no attachments, no images. Links and attachments are fine later, when the person has replied and asked for them.

A real signature and postal address

The workflow adds your **signOff** (`Thanks,` unless you change it) and your signature from ⚙️ *Settings*: **yourName**, **yourBusinessName**, **yourWebsite**, **yourPhone** and **yourAddress**. Fill in all five, in every Client Finder workflow you use and in the Follow-up Autopilot. **yourAddress** is optional in the workflow, and the results page reminds you while it is empty. But US commercial email must include a valid physical postal address (CAN-SPAM), and a real address builds trust everywhere. A real street or business address in your own country counts, even if you live outside the US. Don't want to show your home address? For CAN-SPAM, a PO box registered with the US Postal Service, or a private mailbox registered under Postal Service rules, is also accepted. Outside the US, ask a local mailbox service what is accepted where you send. Keep **optOutLine** (first emails) and the Autopilot's **followUpOptOutLine** (follow-ups) switched on. If Gmail adds your normal signature to a draft too, remove one.

Your daily 45-minute routine

Do this every working day, in four blocks. Regular work matters more than volume.

1. Start one search (5 minutes)

Open your bookmarked *Find Clients Form* page. Type one business type and one area, choose 20 or 40 businesses and submit. A run takes about 2-8 minutes; wait for it to finish before you submit another search. Meanwhile, open Gmail: if someone replied with interest, answer them first.

> **Tip:** Keep the form's link private. The setup guide shows how to lock the form with a username and password (n8n's Basic Auth).

2. Review and send the best 10-20 (15 minutes)

1. In your sheet, click the small filter icon in the **Score** header and choose **Sort Z → A**, so the highest scores come first. Look at **Hot** and **Warm** leads with the status **Draft ready**.
2. In Gmail, open **Drafts** and use the 30-second checklist below on each one.
3. Send the best 10-20 (about 10 in your first week). Delete any draft you don't believe in.
4. Follow-up drafts from the Autopilot are here too (subject "Re: ..."). Check them the same way.

> **Tip:** Writing to another time zone? In Gmail, click the small arrow next to **Send** and choose **Schedule send**, so your email arrives in their morning.

3. Calls, DMs and replies (20 minutes)

Click the filter icon in the **Status** header and show only **Pitch ready**: these leads have a pitch but no Gmail draft. Call or message 3-5 of them, using the **Call Opener** and **DM Message** columns. Then answer every reply, even a "no" (see "Handling replies").

4. Log statuses (5 minutes)

Update **Status** for every lead you touched: **Contacted** after you email or call, then **Replied**, **Meeting booked**, **Won**, **Lost**, **Not interested** or **Do not contact**. The Follow-up Autopilot sets **Contacted**, **Follow-up drafted**, **Replied** and **Bounced** for leads you emailed; calls and DMs are yours to log. Add short notes in **Notes**, such as `6 Oct: called, left voicemail`.

How to review a draft in 30 seconds

You are the sender, and automated checks can be wrong. They are careful: when a check can't be sure, it makes no claim, and **Notes** often says why (for example "Homepage not checked in detail"). But they read only the homepage's code, so a booking button or chat that loads later, or sits on another page, can be missed. PageSpeed is a simulated phone test, and its score changes a little on each run. Always look before you send.

Open the draft and the business's website side by side. Check eight things:

1. **The evidence is true when you look.** The **Evidence** column says exactly what was found, for example: "The footer of their homepage still shows © 2019, which suggests the site hasn't been updated in about 7 years." Open the website on your phone. Is it really slow? Does the footer really say © 2019? Is there really no booking button? If not, delete the draft.

2. **The name and address are right.** The greeting uses a short name, like "Hi Sunrise Family Dental team,". Fix anything odd, such as a slogan in the name. The address in **To** should look like the business's own.
3. **One problem.** The email leads with the single biggest problem. If it lists several, cut it down.
4. **One offer.** Your free next step, clear and small.
5. **One question.** It ends with one simple yes/no question.
6. **The tone fits.** Polite, plain, no pressure. Change any word you would not say.
7. **The signature is complete.** Your name, business, website, phone and postal address.
8. **The opt-out line is there.** The "P.S." line stays in first emails. Follow-ups end with "If you'd rather I didn't follow up, just reply and I'll stop."

If the facts are wrong, delete the draft. Never "fix" evidence by guessing.

If **AI Status** says "Template used (AI error: ...)", Claude couldn't write that pitch, and the draft is the niche's template ("I was looking at how ... shows up online, and one thing stood out: ..."). Check it the same way, and make it sound like you.

DRAFT · EXAMPLE OUTPUT

To info@sunrise-dental.test
Subject Your website on phones

Hi Sunrise Family Dental team,

I ran your website through Google's PageSpeed test on mobile and it scored 23 out of 100. On a phone, the main content takes about 9.8 seconds to appear, and the footer still says © 2019.

When a page is that slow, many people searching for a dentist simply tap the next result on Google Maps.

I help Austin practices with website design and redesign. Would it be useful if I sent you a free 2-minute video showing exactly what I would fix?

Thanks,
Asha Rao
Pixel & Pine Studio
pixelpine.studio

P.S. If this isn't useful, just reply "no thanks" and I won't email again.

*Example data: a first email to the example business Sunrise Family Dental. Fill in **yourPhone** and **yourAddress** so your own signature shows them too.*

Recording the free video audit

When someone replies "yes, send the video", send it within 24 hours if you can, and within 48 hours at most.

The 2-minute structure

Time	What to say and show
0:00-0:15	Hello, your name, and why you are sending this: "You said yes to a short video about your website."
0:15-1:15	The problem, on their real website or profile. Show it; don't just describe it.
1:15-1:45	What you would fix: 2-3 points, in plain words.
1:45-2:00	One next step: "If this is useful, reply and we can have a 15-minute call."

What to show in each niche

- **Web Design:** the homepage on your phone, or in your browser's phone view (in Chrome, press F12, or Cmd+Option+I on a Mac, then click the phone icon). Run the test live at pagespeed.web.dev, Google's own tool. Point at the old © year.
- **Local SEO:** search Google as a customer would, for example "dentist near South Congress Austin". Show who appears first and what their listings have that this one lacks.
- **Google Reviews & Reputation:** their Google Maps listing next to two nearby competitors. Compare ratings and review counts, and show how simple a review request could be.
- **Social Media & Ads:** their website with no social links, their Instagram if they have one, and one or two posts you would make.
- **AI Chatbots & Booking:** try to book on their website as a customer would at 9 pm on a Saturday. Then show what an assistant could answer.

How to record

- **Any screen recorder works.** Mac and Windows both have one built in. Your face in a small circle is optional.
- **Record in one take.** Small mistakes are human; don't spend an hour editing.
- **Prepare your screen.** Close other tabs, turn off notifications and zoom in. Never show other clients' data.
- **Be kind.** Someone the owner knows may have built the site. Say "this is slowing you down", not "this is terrible".
- **Send a link.** Upload it as an *unlisted* video (only people with the link can watch it) and put the link in your reply. A link is fine now, because they asked.

End your reply with the same next step as the video: a short call.

Calls and DMs for leads without email

Pitch ready leads have a pitch but no Gmail draft, usually because their homepage shows no email address. Many have no website at all (**Notes** says "No website: call or DM instead."), or Google links only to a Facebook, booking or delivery page (**Notes** says which). Don't skip them: for a web designer, a busy business with no website may be the clearest need of all. If a **Pitch ready** lead does have an **Email** (the draft failed, or drafts are off), copy the **Email Body** into a new Gmail message instead.

Phone calls

1. Call in business hours, but not at obviously busy times, like lunchtime for a restaurant.
2. Ask for the owner or manager. Use the **Call Opener** column as your first sentence.
3. Ask permission: "Have you got 30 seconds?" If not, ask when to call back.
4. Say the one problem, then the offer. Then stop and listen.
5. Interested? Ask for the best email address and send the free offer the same day.
6. A no? Thank them, set **Not interested** and move on. If they ask you never to contact them again, set **Do not contact**.

> **Example:** Example data. Lakeside Dental Care has 4.8 stars from 340 reviews but no website on its Google listing. Call opener: "Hi, this is Asha from Pixel & Pine Studio. Lakeside Dental Care has great reviews on Google Maps but no website on its listing, so people can't learn more or book. Is the owner or practice manager around?"

Voicemail

Keep it under 20 seconds, and leave one, not five. Example:

"Hi, this is Asha Rao from Pixel & Pine Studio. I noticed your Google listing has no website, and I had a quick idea for you. My number is 512 555 0199. Again, 512 555 0199. Thanks!" (Example name and number.)

Instagram, Facebook and WhatsApp messages

Use the **DM Message** column. It is short (at most 45 words) and casual.

- **One message at a time, by hand.** Platforms can limit or block accounts that send bulk or automated unsolicited messages.
- **Short and personal.** Their name and the one problem; no links, attachments or voice notes.

- **WhatsApp:** only message a number the business shows for customer messages, such as a "WhatsApp us" button.
- **One follow-up at most.** No answer after about a week? Stop.

Contact forms

The workflow does not fill in forms. On the website's contact page, paste a short version of the **Email Body** by hand, with your email address. Respect notices like "no sales enquiries". In some countries, such a notice also means you may not email them (see "Rules for cold email").

> **Warning:** Calls and texts have their own rules. This is not legal advice. In the UK, don't make sales calls to numbers registered with the TPS or CTPS (the UK's do-not-call lists for people and businesses); check a number before you call. In the US, federal do-not-call rules mostly cover personal numbers, but never use auto-dialers or pre-recorded messages, never send marketing texts without written consent, and check your state's rules. In India, TRAI rules, including the Do Not Disturb register, cover promotional calls and SMS, and operators can act against numbers that make many unsolicited promotional calls. Make a few personal, relevant calls by hand, and stop when asked.

Following up

Busy owners miss emails. One or two polite follow-ups give them a second chance.

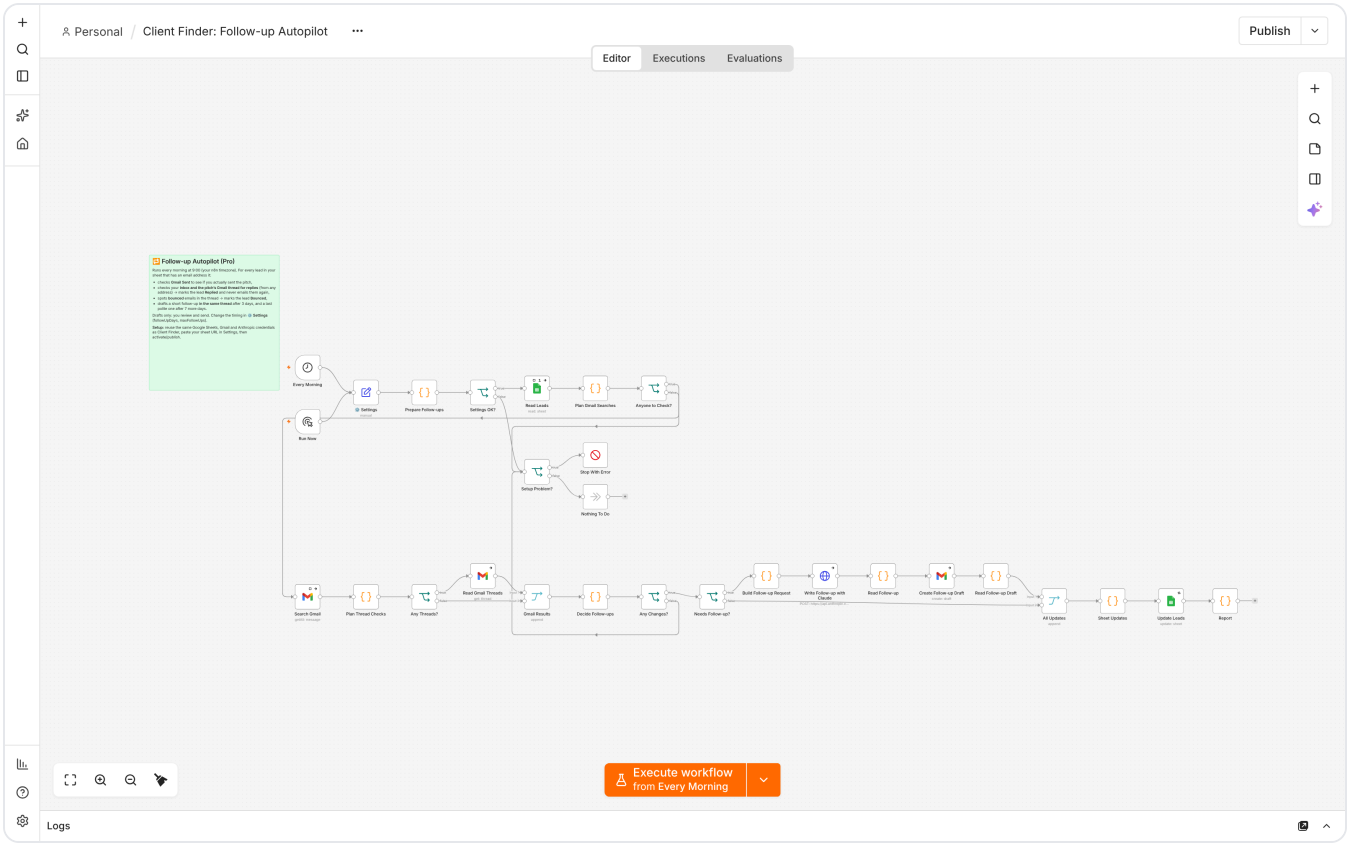
What the Follow-up Autopilot does

The Follow-up Autopilot runs every morning at 9:00 in your n8n time zone (the *Every Morning* node), or when you run it by hand (the *Run Now* node). For every lead with an email address, it reads your Gmail from the last 120 days: what you sent to that address, what came from that address (even archived, deleted or in spam), and every message in the Gmail threads your pitches were sent in.

- **Someone replied** after your first email: **Status** becomes **Replied**, and they never get a follow-up. A reply in your pitch's thread counts even from another address, such as a colleague or the owner's personal email; **Notes** then says who replied. Out-of-office auto-replies don't count.
- **Your email bounced** (a delivery failure came back in the thread): **Status** becomes **Bounced**, and that address is never emailed again. "Delivery delayed" notices don't count.
- **They replied or it bounced while a follow-up draft was waiting: Notes** tells you to delete that draft. Do it before your next send.
- **You never sent the draft:** nothing happens.
- **You sent it and 3 or more days passed with no reply:** it drafts follow-up #1 in the same Gmail thread ("Re: ...").

- **You sent follow-up #1 and 7 or more days passed with no reply:** it drafts follow-up #2, a short, polite last note.
- **Then it stops**, because **maxFollowUps** is 2. (Raise it and the extra follow-ups each add a new angle; only the last one closes the loop.)

Every follow-up ends with your signature and **followUpOptOutLine**: "If you'd rather I didn't follow up, just reply and I'll stop." An unsent follow-up draft blocks new ones, so you never get duplicates. Leads with the status **Replied**, **Meeting booked**, **Won**, **Lost**, **Do not contact**, **Not interested** or **Bounced**, or any status you typed yourself, are never touched, and an address with one of those statuses on any row is never emailed from another row. If Gmail can't be read (a search or thread read fails), the run stops with an error and drafts nothing that day; the next run tries again. PRO-GUIDE.pdf explains the setup.



The Follow-up Autopilot. It only creates drafts; you send them.

What to check yourself

- **Keep the opt-out line.** It is added for you. If you empty **followUpOptOutLine**, write your own line into each follow-up: in the US, CAN-SPAM expects an opt-out in every commercial email.
- **Bounces.** Most bounces come back in the same Gmail thread, and the Autopilot marks those **Bounced**. If you see one it missed, set **Bounced** yourself. Then try a call or DM.
- **Other automatic answers.** Out-of-office replies with a usual subject ("Automatic reply", "Out of office") are ignored. Other automatic messages, like "Thanks, we got your email", can still mark a

lead **Replied**. Open the thread, and follow up by hand later if it makes sense.

- **A new email from another address** (not a reply in your thread) can't be linked. Set **Replied** yourself.
- **Failed drafts.** If Gmail refuses a follow-up draft, a dated note goes at the front of **Notes** (your own notes are kept), and the next run tries again.
- **Calls and DMs** are not followed up for you. Do it by hand, once.

When to stop

Stop after the first email and two follow-ups. With no answer about two weeks after the last one, set **Status** to **Lost**. Never follow up after a no (set **Not interested**), and don't restart the same pitch with a "fresh" email.

Handling replies

Answer every reply within one working day. Short, human and honest beats clever. TEMPLATES.pdf has longer versions of each answer.

They say	You do	New status
"Yes, send it" or "Sounds interesting"	Send the free offer within 24-48 hours, then offer a short call	**Replied**, then **Meeting booked**
"How much?"	Give an honest range and offer a short call	**Replied**
"Send more info"	Send the free offer, 2-3 lines about you and one real example of your work (never invent one)	**Replied**
"Not now"	Thank them and ask if you may check in later	**Replied** or **Lost**, with a date in **Notes**
"Who are you? How did you get my email?"	Explain honestly	Depends on their answer
"No, we're not interested"	Thank them in one line and stop	**Not interested**
"Stop", "Unsubscribe" or "No thanks"	Stop the same day	**Do not contact**
A delivery failure (bounce)	Look for another way to reach them: a call or DM	**Bounced** (the Autopilot sets it for bounces in the thread)

Interested: book a call

Offer two specific times, or a booking link (links are fine now): "Great, I'll send the video by tomorrow. Would Tuesday at 10:00 or Wednesday at 15:00, your time, work for a 15-minute call?" Set **Meeting**

booked when they accept.

"How much?"

Don't dodge. Give an honest range from your real prices, say what changes the price, then ask a question: "It depends on the number of pages and whether you need online booking. Websites like yours usually cost between [your low price] and [your high price] with me. Would a 15-minute call help me give you an exact price?"

"Not now"

"No problem, thanks for letting me know. Would it be OK if I checked in again in a few months?" If yes, write the date in **Notes** (for example `Check in: Feb 2027`) and set a calendar reminder. If not, set **Lost**.

"Who are you? How did you get my email?"

Be honest and calm. The true answer is simple and fair:

"Fair question. I'm Asha, a web designer at Pixel & Pine Studio. I found Sunrise Family Dental on Google Maps, and your email address is published on your website's homepage. I wrote because your homepage scored low in Google's mobile speed test. If you'd rather not hear from me, I won't email again."

The **Website**, **Google Maps** and **Search** columns show where each lead came from. If they ask you to stop, set **Do not contact**.

Unsubscribe requests

Set **Status** to **Do not contact** the same day, before anything else, and delete any follow-up waiting for them in Gmail **Drafts** (the Autopilot never deletes drafts). From then on, the Autopilot never emails that address again, and Client Finder never pitches that address or website again, even from another row or listing. Keep the row, or at least its **Place ID**, **Email** and **Status**: it stops future searches from adding the business again, and it records that you honored the request. A one-line reply is polite but optional: "Done, you won't hear from me again. Sorry for the bother."

Turning a reply into a paying client

A reply starts a conversation, not a sale. The usual path is a short call, then a clear proposal.

The discovery call (20 minutes)

A *discovery call* is a short call to understand their business before you suggest anything. Agenda:

1. **The plan** (1 minute): "I'll ask a few questions, then share what I'd suggest. Is 20 minutes still OK?"

2. **Their business** (5 minutes): Who are their best customers? Where do new customers come from today?
3. **The problem** (5 minutes): Show the evidence and ask, "How does this affect you?" Let them describe the cost in their own words.
4. **What they have tried** (3 minutes): A previous designer, an agency, or doing it themselves? What went wrong?
5. **Budget, timing and decision** (3 minutes): "Do you have a budget in mind? When do you need this? Does anyone else decide with you?"
6. **Next step** (3 minutes): "I'll send a one-page proposal by Thursday. Can we talk on Friday to go through it?"

Listen more than you talk, and write short notes in **Notes**.

A one-page proposal

Keep it short and use their words:

1. **Their goal**, in one sentence.
2. **What you found**: the evidence, in plain words.
3. **What you will do**: exactly what is included.
4. **What is not included**, so there are no surprises.
5. **Timeline**: start date and delivery date.
6. **Price**: two or three options (see below).
7. **What you need from them**: logo, photos, logins.
8. **How to say yes**: reply "yes", sign, or pay a deposit. Many freelancers ask for part of the fee up front.

Send it within 48 hours of the call, then follow up once after 2-3 days.

Pricing approaches

- **Fixed packages.** One clear price for a clear result, like "5-page website". Easy to say yes to.
- **Retainers.** A *retainer* is a monthly fee for ongoing work, like SEO, social media, reviews or chatbot updates.
- **Good, better, best.** Three versions of one package, so the owner chooses an option instead of yes or no.
- **Setup plus monthly.** A one-time fee plus a smaller monthly fee. It fits chatbots and review systems.

Niche	One-time package (example)	Monthly option (example)	What changes the price
Web Design	a small business website	a care plan: hosting, updates, small edits	number of pages, online booking, who writes the text
Local SEO	a setup: fixes to the website and Google profile	ongoing local SEO work and a short monthly report	number of locations, how much content is needed
Google Reviews & Reputation	a review request system: messages, QR code, staff steps	monitoring, and help answering reviews	number of locations, how many reviews they get
Social Media & Ads	a content starter pack	posting and ad management, plus the ad budget they pay	posts per month, number of platforms, ad spend
AI Chatbots & Booking	an assistant set up on their website	hosting, updates and new answers	booking system, languages, number of questions

Important: We don't give price numbers on purpose. Prices vary a lot by country, city, niche, scope and experience. To set yours, look at what 5-10 freelancers and agencies in your target market publish on their websites, then choose a price you can explain and deliver.

Metrics to track with the Pipeline tab

The **Pipeline** tab counts your leads per status and per priority, updated from the **Leads** tab. Its **Reply rate** row shows leads marked **Replied**, **Meeting booked** or **Won**, divided by all leads you contacted (**Contacted**, **Follow-up drafted**, **Replied**, **Meeting booked**, **Won** and **Lost**). **Do not contact**, **Not interested** and **Bounced** leads are not counted. Treat it as a rough guide: it is only as accurate as your statuses.

Four numbers to write down every Friday

Number	Where to find it
Sent	First emails you sent this week (Gmail **Sent**, or the change in **Contacted** and later statuses)
Replies	Every human reply, including "no"
Calls	Discovery calls held (**Meeting booked**)
Wins	**Won**

Pipeline counts are running totals, so each Friday copy them into a small table (a new tab is fine; keep the **Leads** tab and its header row unchanged) and subtract last week's numbers. To track calls and DMs, add a column to the right of **Notes**, such as `Channel` (Email, Call or DM). The workflows ignore columns there.

Improve one thing at a time

Results vary widely by niche, country, offer and season, so we can't tell you what a "good" reply rate is. Compare yourself with your own last month.

1. Change one thing: the business type, the area, the offer, the subject line or the first sentence.
2. Keep everything else the same.
3. Send a few dozen emails with the change before you judge it. Small numbers mislead: 2 replies from 10 emails can be luck.
4. Keep what works, then change the next thing.

Start with the list (niche, business types, areas): a great offer cannot help businesses that don't need you. If nobody replies at all, check your inbox setup first (SPF, DKIM and DMARC should show `PASS`).

Rules for cold email

> **Important:** This is a general overview, not legal advice. Laws change, and they have exceptions this page leaves out. Check the rules for the recipient's country, and get local advice when you are unsure.

The recipient's country usually decides which email rules apply. The laws of your own country can apply too.

United States: CAN-SPAM

CAN-SPAM covers all commercial email, including email from one business to another. You don't need permission first, but you must:

- Use honest "From" details and an honest subject line.
- Make clear that the email is a commercial message, such as an offer of your services.
- Identify yourself and include a valid physical postal address.
- Include a working way to opt out, keep it working for at least 30 days after you send, and honor opt-outs within 10 business days. You can't charge for opting out or ask for more than a reply email or a visit to one web page.

Your signature goes on every first email and follow-up, so fill in **yourAddress** before you email US businesses (it is optional in the workflow, but the results page reminds you while it is empty). The opt-out is automatic: **optOutLine** ends every first email, and **followUpOptOutLine** ends every follow-up. Keep both on, and set **Do not contact** the same day someone opts out.

United Kingdom: PECR and UK GDPR

- **Limited companies, LLPs and other corporate bodies:** under PECR (the UK's rules on electronic marketing), you can generally email their business addresses without consent first. You must say who you are and give a working way to opt out.
- **Sole traders and some partnerships** are treated like individuals: you generally need their consent first. Many small local businesses are sole traders, so check for "Ltd" or a company number on their website, or search the Companies House register.
- **UK GDPR** (the data protection law) also applies when an address identifies a person, like `jane.smith@...`. You need a lawful reason to use it, usually *legitimate interests*: a real business reason that is fair to the person. You must also tell them who you are, where you got their details and how to object, at the latest in your first message. A common way: put a short privacy notice on your website, and add one line to your email, such as "You can read how I handle your details on my website." Your website is already in your signature, so you don't need an extra link. If they object, stop.

European Union: GDPR and national ePrivacy rules

GDPR applies across the EU, but marketing email rules come from each country's ePrivacy law, and they vary. Some countries allow B2B email with an opt-out; others require consent first, even for businesses. For example, Germany generally requires consent first, even for business addresses, while France generally allows emails to professional addresses about the person's work, with an opt-out. When an address names a person, the GDPR points above apply too.

Canada: CASL

CASL is strict: you need consent first, with limited exceptions. One is *implied consent* through publication: the person conspicuously published their address (for example on their website), there is no statement nearby saying they don't want unsolicited messages, and your message is relevant to their business role. Every message must identify you, give your mailing address and one other way to reach you (phone, email or website), and include a working unsubscribe. Honor unsubscribes within 10 business days.

Australia: Spam Act 2003

You need consent, but it can be *inferred* when someone, such as an owner or employee, conspicuously publishes their work address, with no statement refusing unsolicited messages, and your message relates to their work role. Identify yourself and include a working unsubscribe. Honor unsubscribes within 5 working days.

India

India has no specific anti-spam law for email. The Digital Personal Data Protection Act 2023 (DPDP Act) covers digital personal data, such as a named person's email address, and its rules are coming into force in stages. If you work from India, it may apply to the lead data you keep. The Act does not cover personal data that a person made public themselves, but it is not yet clear how that applies to an email address on a business website. Calls and SMS have their own TRAI rules (see "Calls and DMs for leads without email").

Everywhere

- Write to businesses about their business, and be honest about who you are and why you write.
- Honor every opt-out at once: set **Do not contact** the same day.
- Keep records for the leads you contact. The sheet shows where each lead came from (**Search** and **Google Maps**) and when you found it (**Found On**).
- Treat your sheet as a working list. Client Finder Agent uses Google's official Places API with your own key, not a scraper. Google's Maps Platform Terms (section 3.2.3) restrict storing Places content such as business names and addresses outside Google's services (Place IDs may be kept), so read the terms and delete leads you don't pursue. To delete one and still keep it from coming back, clear its other cells and keep only **Place ID**, **Email** and **Status**.
- Keep the **Place ID**, **Email** and **Status** of people who opted out. That is your record that you honored the request, and it stops the business from being added again.
- If someone asks you to delete their details (a right under GDPR and similar laws), clear everything except the **Place ID**, the **Email** and the **Do not contact** status. The business is then not added again and that address is never emailed again; keeping just the address on a do-not-contact list is the usual way to honour the request (regulators such as the UK ICO accept this kind of suppression record).

A 30-day launch plan

Week 1: set up and practise

1. **Days 1-2:** Set up your Google Workspace address with SPF, DKIM and DMARC. Fill in all five signature fields in ⚙️ *Settings*.
2. **Day 3:** Choose one niche, 3 business types and 5-10 areas. Write your **yourOffer**.
3. **Day 4:** Run your first search of 20 businesses. Record one practice video audit for a lead (don't send it) and time yourself.
4. **Days 5-7:** Follow the daily routine with about 10 emails a day, plus 3 calls or DMs.

Week 2: build the habit

About 15 emails a day if bounces are rare. Turn on the Follow-up Autopilot (see PRO-GUIDE.pdf). Write your proposal template and 2-3 priced packages.

Week 3: conversations

About 20 emails a day if your inbox is healthy. Hold discovery calls and send proposals within 48 hours. On Friday, write down your four numbers.

Week 4: review and adjust

Read your **Pipeline** tab and Friday numbers. Which business types and areas got replies? Choose one thing to change next month, and decide whether to add a second niche.

By day 30 you will have a working routine and real numbers from your own market. Winning a client can take longer than a month. Your numbers will show you what to change next.

Common mistakes

1. **Sending without reading.** One wrong fact makes you look careless, and your name is on it.
2. **Too many emails too soon.** A new inbox that sends 100 cold emails on day one may land in spam.
3. **Asking for too much.** Offer something small and free before any call.
4. **Hype and promises.** "Guaranteed first page" or "triple your bookings" damages trust.
5. **Ignoring calls and DMs. Pitch ready** leads can be the businesses that need you most.
6. **Slow replies.** A "yes" that waits three days can go cold.
7. **Deleting whole rows.** Clear a lead you won't pursue, but keep its **Place ID**, **Email** and **Status**. Without them, the business can come back in a future search, and you lose your record of opt-outs.
8. **Giving up after one week.** The first week is mostly setup and learning.

Questions about the workflows? Email support@example.com. Never send your API keys.

This playbook is for Client Finder Agent version 1.0.0.